fear.[136] Nehru disagreed with Mao that war should be welcomed if it came. Responding to the chairman, Nehru asserted that, while the Defense Department's growing influence was problematic, most Americans, including many in government, did not want war. He included Eisenhower in the latter category, explaining that any inconsistency in the president's position was thanks to his "third-rate advisers."[137]

Publicly, Nehru denied reports that China and India had sharp differences, noting that, while in some cases their basic approaches were different, there were no disagreements during the talks.[138] He insisted that following different paths did not inevitably lead to conflict.[139] Privately, Nehru told Zhou that he hoped that any differences would not preclude cooperation.[140]

Washington watched this trip closely, coming as it did after the Manila Pact creating SEATO. Dulles thought that Nehru's visit to China might be "on balance, advantageous to the West." He believed that the prime minister's China policy stemmed from "admiration and fear in about equal proportions." He hoped that the visit would heighten that fear via a better understanding of the "implications for India of Chinese Communist policies and strength."[141] But, after his trip, Nehru publicly contradicted Dulles's assertion that there was no proof that China had changed intentions.[142] Mirror-imaging again, he asserted this view privately as well, stating that he had "no doubt at all that the Government and the people of China desire peace and want to concentrate on building up their country during the next decade or two."[143]

The US, concerned about the impact of improved Sino-Indian relations, tried to foster Sino-Indian dissension. One way was to suggest that India replace China on the UN Security Council. This could also help settle the two-Chinas problem.[144] The idea was not new—as an adviser to the Truman State Department, Dulles had suggested to Pandit in August 1950 that "America might be happy" with such a move (she had thought it inadvisable given Sino-Indian relations).[145] Nehru would later tell Soviet leaders in 1955 that he opposed this, primarily on the grounds that it was intended to disrupt the Sino-Indian relationship. It was not quite clear how Washington planned to bring Moscow on board. The latter only indicated to Delhi that it might suggest India's inclusion as a sixth member "at a later stage."[146] Nehru eventually acknowledged that the substitution plan might